

NexPharma Analytics: Google Drive Shared Folder + Power BI Setup Guide

This guide explains how to store the raw data files in a shared Google Drive folder while keeping the Power BI dashboard file (`.pbix`) on each user's local computer.

The goal is simple: - One person updates the raw files - Everyone else opens their local PBIX file and clicks Refresh - No paid Google Workspace subscription required

1. Recommended Folder Structure

Create the following structure inside Google Drive:

```
NexPharma_Analytics/  
├── Dashboard/  
├── Data_Input/  
│   └── 01_raw/  
├── Exports/  
└── Documentation/
```

Suggested usage:

Folder	Purpose
Dashboard	Store the latest PBIX file for users to download if needed
Data_Input/01_raw	Store the raw CSV / Excel files used by Power BI
Exports	Store exported reports, PDFs, screenshots, etc.
Documentation	Store user guides, export instructions, SOPs

Example:

```
NexPharma_Analytics/  
├── Dashboard/  
│   └── NexPharma Dashboard.pbix  
├── Data_Input/  
│   └── 01_raw/  
│       ├── sales_order.csv  
│       └── invoice.csv
```



2. Folder Owner Setup

The person responsible for updating the raw files should:

1. Create the `NexPharma_Analytics` folder in Google Drive.
2. Create the subfolders shown above.
3. Upload the latest raw files into:

Data_Input/01_raw/

1. Share the main `NexPharma_Analytics` folder with all users.
2. Give:
3. "Editor" access to anyone who needs to update files
4. "Viewer" access to users who only need to refresh the dashboard

3. Setup Required for Every User

Each user must install Google Drive on their computer.

Use:

- Google Drive for desktop

After installing:

1. Sign in using the Google account that received access to the shared folder.
2. Open Google Drive in the browser.
3. Find the shared `NexPharma_Analytics` folder under "Shared with me".
4. Right-click the folder.
5. Select:

Add shortcut to Drive

1. Add the shortcut into:

My Drive

This is important because it makes the folder appear in a more consistent location for all users.

4. Expected Folder Path on the Computer

After Google Drive syncs, the folder should appear on the user's computer at something similar to:

G:\My Drive\NexPharma_Analytics

The raw files should therefore appear at:

G:\My Drive\NexPharma_Analytics\Data_Input\01_raw

Example file path:

G:\My Drive\NexPharma_Analytics\Data_Input\01_raw\sales_order.csv

5. Power BI Setup

Each user keeps the PBIX file on their own computer.

Recommended:

C:\Users\<username>\Documents\NexPharma Dashboard

Example:

C:\Users\John\Documents\NexPharma Dashboard\NexPharma Dashboard.pbix

Then in Power BI:

1. Open the PBIX file.
2. Go to:

Home → Transform Data → Data Source Settings

1. Select the existing file/folder source.
2. Click:

Change Source...

1. Point it to:

G:\My Drive\NexPharma_Analytics\Data_Input\01_raw

1. Apply the changes.
2. Save the PBIX file.

After this is done once, Power BI should remember the path.

6. Daily Usage Workflow

Whenever new data is available:

1. The data owner replaces the files inside:

NexPharma_Analytics/Data_Input/01_raw/

1. File names must stay exactly the same.

For example:

Correct:

sales_order.csv → replace with newer sales_order.csv

Incorrect:

sales_order_mar2026.csv
sales_order_new.csv

1. Google Drive syncs the updated files automatically to everyone's computer.
2. Each user opens their local PBIX file.

3. Click:

Refresh

The dashboard should update automatically.

7. Troubleshooting

Problem: Power BI says file not found

Possible causes: - User did not add the shared folder to "My Drive" - Google Drive has not finished syncing - Folder path is different on that user's computer

Fix:

1. Confirm the files exist here:

G:\My Drive\NexPharma_Analytics\Data_Input\01_raw

1. In Power BI:

Transform Data → Data Source Settings → Change Source

1. Browse to the correct folder manually.

Problem: Google Drive folder appears under "Shared with me"

If the path looks like:

G:\Shared with me\...

Power BI may still work, but the path will differ from other users.

Better fix:

- Add the folder shortcut into "My Drive"
 - Repoint Power BI once
-

Problem: New file name causes errors

Power BI depends on the original file names.

Do not rename: - `sales_order.csv` - `invoice.csv` - `products.csv` - etc.

Only replace the contents of the file.

8. Additional Google Drive Setup Recommendations

To reduce issues across multiple users, configure Google Drive for desktop with these settings:

1. Open Google Drive for desktop settings.
2. Under the shared `NexPharma_Analytics` folder, choose:

Available offline

or use:

Mirror files

This ensures the raw files are actually stored on the computer. If the folder is online-only, Power BI may occasionally fail to find the files, especially after a restart or when the internet connection is unstable.

1. Confirm that Google Drive appears under the same drive letter for all users.

Usually:

G:

If one user's Google Drive appears as `H:\` or another letter, Power BI may not find the files.

To change the drive letter:

- Open Google Drive for desktop settings
- Click the gear icon
- Change the drive letter to `G:` if available
- Users should keep the folder name exactly the same:

NexPharma_Analytics

Do not rename it.

9. Common Troubleshooting

Problem: Google Drive is not syncing

- Check the Google Drive icon in the system tray.
- If it shows paused or signed out, sign back in and resume syncing.
- Wait until Google Drive says `Sync complete` before refreshing Power BI.

Problem: User gets Access Denied

- Confirm the folder was shared with the correct Gmail account.
- Make sure Google Drive for desktop is signed in with that same account.

Problem: Power BI says the file is being used by another process

- Close any CSV or Excel file from `01_raw` that may still be open.
- Wait a few seconds for Google Drive sync to finish.
- Refresh Power BI again.

Problem: Power BI refresh works for some files but not others

Usually caused by: - File renamed - Column names changed - File type changed

Keep the same file names, file types, and folder location.

Problem: User cannot see the shared folder in Google Drive for desktop

1. Open Google Drive in the browser.
2. Go to `Shared with me`
3. Find `NexPharma_Analytics`
4. Select `Add shortcut to Drive`
5. Add it into `My Drive`

Rule: Always Open the PBIX from Your Local Computer

All users must copy the PBIX file from:

NexPharma_Analytics/Dashboard/

onto their own computer before using it.

Recommended local location:

C:\Users\<username>\Documents\NexPharma Dashboard

Users should never open the PBIX directly from Google Drive.

Reason: - PBIX files do not support multiple users opening and saving the same file reliably - Google Drive sync may create duplicate or conflicted copies - Power BI usually runs faster and more reliably when the PBIX is stored locally

This should be treated as a standard rule for all users:

Always refresh and work from your own local PBIX copy. Google Drive is only for sharing the raw data files and distributing the latest master PBIX if needed.

10. Suggested User Instructions

Before using the dashboard: 1. Make sure Google Drive for desktop is running 2. Confirm the shared folder is synced under: G:\My Drive\NexPharma_Analytics\Data_Input\01_raw\ 3. Wait until Google Drive shows "Sync complete" 4. Open the PBIX file on your computer 5. Click Refresh